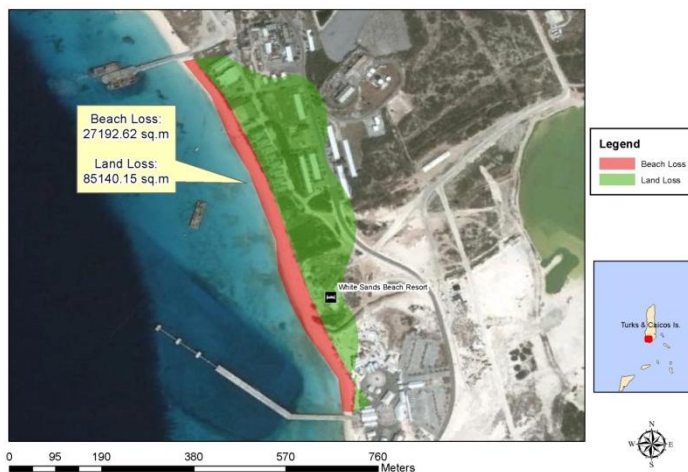


TURKS AND CAICOS ISLANDS: CARIBSAVE Climate Change Risk Atlas (CCCRA), Phase I 'Snapshot' Results

Climate change is a serious threat to the economies of Caribbean nations, community livelihoods, environments and infrastructure. The Turks and Caicos Islands (TCI) is already experiencing sea level rise and consequent coastal erosion, destructive weather systems and periods of drought. As the climate changes, the extent of such effects is expected to become worse.

Tourism, TCI's largest economic sector, is highly dependent on coastal infrastructure and the attractiveness of the natural coastal environment. This has been shown to be vulnerable to sea level rise (SLR) and storm surge. Cedar Grove Beach has already suffered from substantial beach loss.

Turks and Caicos Islands: Land Loss From Sea Level Rise Grand Turk Cruise Center: Grand Turk Island



SLR modelling was conducted under the Risk Atlas for beaches with high-end tourism resorts at Grand Turk Cruise Centre, Grand Turk West Shore and Historic Cockburn Town. Results show:

- A 0.5 m SLR will result in the loss of more than half of the beach area in Grand Turk West Shore (53%) and Historic Cockburn Town (65%).
- Between 61% and 81% of beach area would be lost across all sites with a 1 m SLR.
- All of the beach area will be lost in Historic Cockburn Town under a 2 m SLR scenario and almost all at the other two sites (94% and 97%).

The Risk Atlas provides robust and meaningful data and practical analyses in key socioeconomic sectors as they relate to tourism: *Community Livelihoods, Gender, Poverty and Development; Agriculture and Food Security; Energy; Water Quality and Availability; Sea Level Rise and Storm Surge Impacts on Coastal Infrastructure and Settlements; Comprehensive Disaster Management; Human Health; and Marine and Terrestrial Biodiversity and Fisheries.*

The **Community Vulnerability Assessment of Lower Bight, Providenciales** has increased the awareness about climate change risks to the residents there, and can further assist:

- The Government of TCI in reviewing disaster planning in this area with livelihood and demographic characteristics (including gender) in mind. In particular in assessing the suitability of existing shelters and possibility of establishing local emergency services.
- The residents, especially community leaders and change agents, in developing a community level disaster group that can carry out projects such as tree-planting and drain maintenance, but also raise awareness on the importance of insurance and other support mechanisms.
- In identifying the climate change issues in other coastal communities, as well as risk profiling, adaptive capacity analysis and building resilience and capacity in communities.

Moreover, the Risk Atlas provides the evidence-base for specific, pragmatic action and adaptation responses.

Preliminary action plans are identified for planners, tourism operators and other national and sectoral stakeholders to: protect their assets and ecosystems on which they depend; guide the intersectoral dialogue necessary for sound socioeconomic development that is climate-resilient; and build the requisite capacity to respond to climate change.